



▼ PIPE PISTOL

Date 1939–45

Origin UK

Barrel Not known

Caliber .22in

Common items carried on the person were capable of being transformed into lethal firing devices. This device from World War II was designed for use by SOE personnel. It was fired by removing the mouthpiece and twisting the bowl while grasping the barrel.

Bowl

Barrel

Muzzle housed within cigarette

Firing string

◀ SINGLE-SHOT CIGARETTE PISTOL

Date 1939–45

Origin UK

Barrel Not known

Caliber .22in

This device disguised as a cigarette was developed at an SOE laboratory. The device was fired when the user pulled on a string with his teeth. Because of its short barrel it had a limited range.

Rear sight

Forestock

Barrel is surrounded by integral sound suppressor

Front sling attachment

Rear sight

Foresight

Barrel containing baffles and wipes to suppress sound

Trigger

Pistol grip containing six-round magazine

▲ WELROD SILENCED PISTOL

Date c.1943

Origin UK

Barrel 12in (30.5cm)

Caliber 9mm

Developed at Station IX—a secret SOE factory—the Welrod was an exceptionally quiet assassination weapon, firing subsonic ammunition (ammunition having a muzzle velocity less than 1,100ft/335m per second). The sights were sometimes marked with fluorescent paint for low-light conditions.